

for me for almost thirty years. I dropped it once, lost it twice (but got it back—always include your name and phone number inside somewhere). When the *Extreme Couponing* show became popular, I noticed the women and men in the show were always using a coupon binder. I had to admit the coupon binders looked nicer than my beat-up old box. The prospect of changing over to a binder was pretty daunting, so until I spotted a black briefcase style binder at a local thrift store, I'd had no intention of ever changing over to one. Honestly, the thrift store find was an impetus, but the fact was, after thirty years of couponing with a box of some sort, I was ready for a change. I liked looking hip with a hobby that, until then, seemed anything but. What I ended up doing was looking like everyone else. For thirty years I'd carried a coupon box with me everywhere and never saw another soul with one. Not one. I didn't see anyone with binders, either, but as soon as I changed from box to binder in May of 2011, I started seeing other "binder ladies" everywhere I went. Not only that, but in changing to a binder I made myself visible as a certain type of couponer, and unfortunately that backfired in some situations with cashiers who'd had it with "those coupon people." Alas, it was too much work to change back to the box, and I'd found I liked the binder better.

I won't go into detail about how to organize your coupons because you will have to find out what way works best for *you*. If you are new to the scene, you might want to check out some YouTube tutorial videos about organizing coupons. There are hundreds of videos, mostly in regards to organizing a binder. Keep in mind that you might want to start small with the coupon wallets that have been perfectly serviceable for eons.